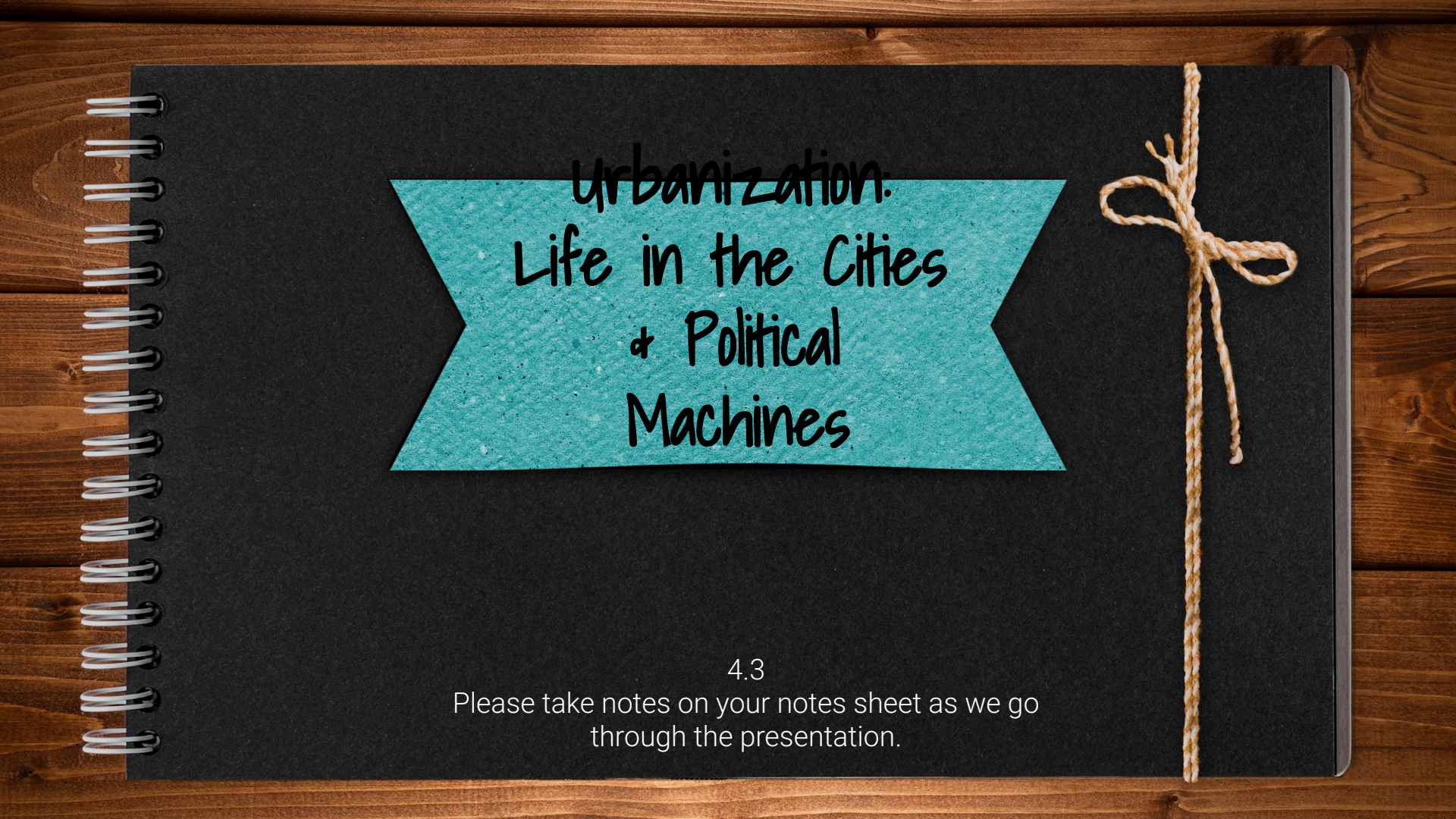


A black spiral-bound notebook is shown from a top-down perspective, lying flat on a dark wooden surface. The notebook's cover is black, and its silver spiral binding is visible on the left side. A teal-colored banner with a slightly textured, paper-like appearance is pasted onto the cover. The banner has a central rectangular area with pointed ends on the left and right sides. On this banner, the text 'Urbanization: Life in the Cities & Political Machines' is written in a black, casual, handwritten-style font. To the right of the banner, a piece of light-brown, twisted rope is tied into a bow, with the ends of the rope hanging down. The background is a dark wooden surface with a visible grain pattern.

Urbanization: Life in the Cities & Political Machines

4.3

Please take notes on your notes sheet as we go through the presentation.

The Gilded Age



What do you think gilded means?

What might it be referring to when we think of the United States in the late 1800s?

The Gilded Age: A Tale of Today is a novel by Mark Twain and Charles Dudley Warner first published in 1873. It satirizes greed and political corruption in post-Civil War America.

(Satire/ Irony/ Sarcasm: EX
South Park...The Office)



The title very quickly became synonymous with graft, materialism, and corruption in public life. The novel gave the era its nickname: the period of U.S. history from the 1870s to about 1900 is now referred to as the Gilded Age.

Politics during the Gilded Age

Alliance between government and business continued to grow

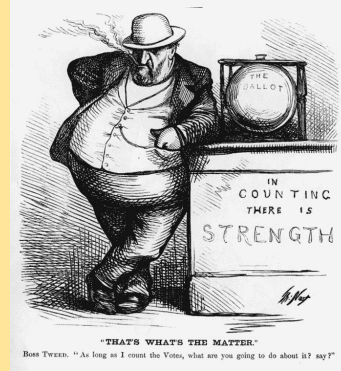


Patronage

Giving government jobs to people who helped you get elected (spoils)

Some were not qualified

If there are a bunch of unqualified people in government positions, what will happen?



Graft

Politician uses their influence for personal gain

This is illegal ex:
kickbacks, bribes
Think Boss Tweed

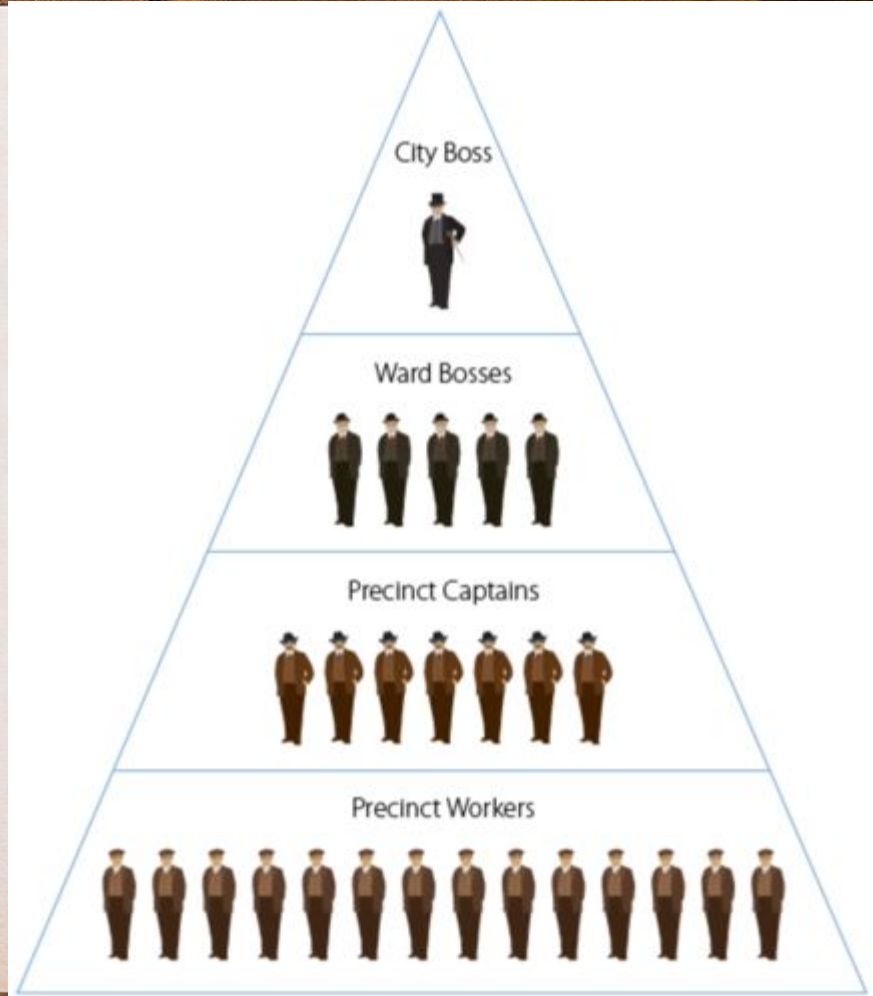


Tariffs

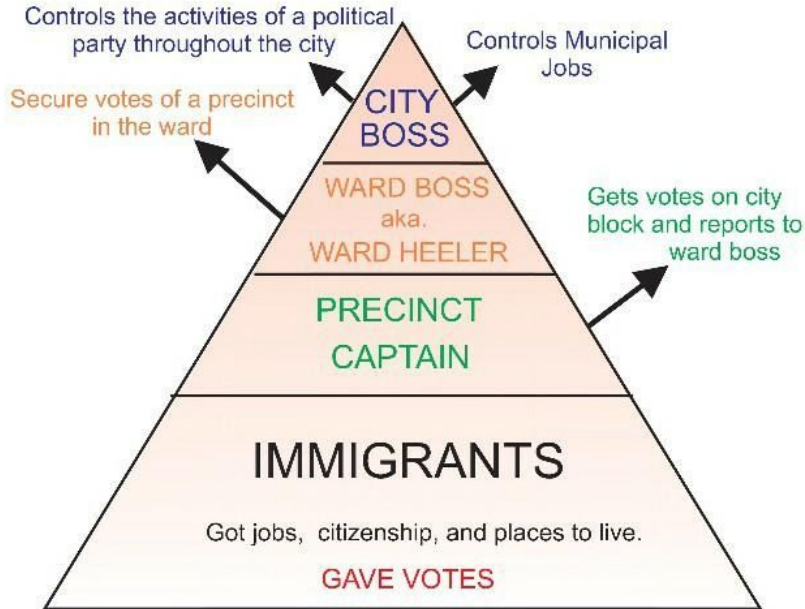
Tax on imports

American Business wanted them high to protect their goods

So what did the politicians do? Who does this hurt?



The Political Machine



Boss Tweed - New York Democrats

Tammany hall

1869 - 1871 pocketed 200 mil. from cities in Kickbacks and payoffs



Thomas Nast

NY Times and Harper's weekly Political cartoons



II Spotlight on Political Machines

What is the role of the Political Machine/Boss?

What do you think was good about this system? Why?

What do you think was bad about this system? Why?

Political Bosses

Large Influence
Paid Well
Gained People's Trust



Positives

Created parks, sewer systems, waterworks
Funded hospitals, schools, orphanages
Helped immigrants become citizens

Negatives

Influenced courts
Access to jobs and business licenses
Some used illegal means for control, bribes
Fixed Elections

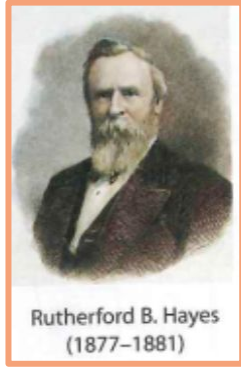
#1 Goal

Votes!!!

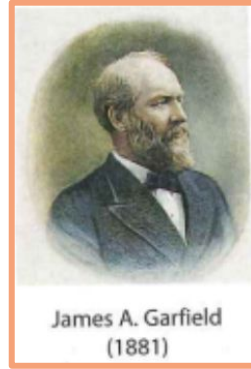
Also wanted money and control

The Do-Nothing Presidents

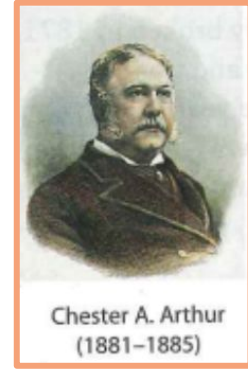
Civil service reform (ending spoils/patronage) is a GRADUAL progress



- 1st president to turn away from **patronage**
- Appointed qualified independents (broke up NYC's customhouse)
- Enraged Republican Party (Stalwarts v. Reformers)



- Republicans nominate Garfield (reformer) for Pres and Arthur (stalwart) for VP
- Garfield still enraged Reps as he gave reformers most of the patronage jobs
- 7.2.81: Shot by Charles Guiteau to get Arthur in office



- Despite Stalwart ties he turned reformer when he was Pres
- **PENDLETON CIVIL SERVICE ACT (1883)**

Pendleton Civil Service Act (1883)

Bipartisan (what does this mean?) group to make appointments to federal jobs through merit system (take a test).

GOOD

- Public administration became more honest and efficient
- Officials could no longer pressure employees for campaign contributions

EFFECTS OF PENDLETON

BAD

- Politicians turned to other sources for donations → wealthy business owners

- Big business leaders want to raise TARIFFS (taxes on imports)

-1884: **Grover Cleveland** (D) elected to lower tariffs but Congress refused

-1892: **Grover Cleveland's** BACK but failed to lower tariffs

-1888: **Benjamin Harrison** (R) elected Pres and signed McKinley Tariff of 1890 → highest level yet

Why "Gilded"?

Why was this time called the gilded age?

What does it mean?

